

CST306 – Ethical Leadership

Midterm Exam: Application Paper (Midterm)

Last Day to Submit: 11.59 PM, March 28, 2026 on TURNITIN and the printed copy on March 29 in the classroom during class time

(Turnitin details are given on the first page of the course outline, and please know that you are not required to work during your Eid vacation)

An example of how to construct an Application Paper:

A. Introduction

- Briefly introduce the topic or article you are applying
- State your purpose: *what* you will apply, *to what* situation, and *why*
- End with a thesis statement that clearly says how the concept connects to the example you'll discuss.

B. Summary of the Concept / Article

- Briefly explain the main ideas of the reading/theory in your own words
- Keep it short (don't re-write the whole article)—just enough so a reader understands your later application.

C. Application to the Real-World Case

- Describe your case or example in enough detail for readers to follow
- Explicitly connect each main idea from the reading/theory to what happened in your example
- Use **specific evidence**—dates, events, quotes, or observations
- Show both similarities and differences

D. Reflection & Analysis

- What did you learn from applying the concept?
- Did it help explain the situation? Did you find limitations?
- How could things have been improved based on what you learned?

E. Conclusion

- Summarize the key points of the application
- End with a broader insight—why is this learning important for your field or society?

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Accepted News Article (online/printed): Prothom Alo (English), Daily Star, BBC, BBC World News, CNN, Reuters, Al Jazeera, MSNBC, NPR, PBS, The Business Standard, Dhaka

Tribune, Financial Express, New Age, etc..

Do not forget to cite all your sources in APA 7th Edition. Both the materials shared in the course outline and google classroom as well as your researched articles.

Topic for the application paper:

- Firstly, pick one leader from column A and another leader from column B. • Secondly, do a deep dive into the leaders' public lives of your chosen leaders. Find out specific events, decisions, activities, etc. for the leaders. From the chosen leader in column A, find an ethical decision that you agree with in a positive manner. From the leader in column B, specify an ethically questionable or outright objectionable choice they made.
- Then, do a comparative analysis in the application paper by using the two examples and seeing how the theories helped you understand the decision making and concerning ethical issues.

<u>Column A</u> <u>Column B</u>	
Begum Rokeya	Elon Musk
Jacinda Ardern	Winston Churchill
Abdul Hamid Khan Bhashani	Elizabeth Holmes
Mahatma Gandhi	Sam Bankman-Fried
J. R. D. Tata	Aung San Suu Kyi
Angela Merkel	Sheikh Hasina

General Instructions:

- You must bring the printed copy of your application paper for it to be evaluated. Submit the printed Application Paper on March 29 during the class time.
- Write between 1800-2000 words including your citations and references. • Analyse the ethical issues raised in the news articles and do a comparison of the chosen leaders' decisions.

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- The analysis will be based on the theoretical discussions of ethics, leaderships

leadership toolkits, foundational factors etc. addressed in the class.

- Attach a printed copy of the news articles with your paper when you submit the hardcopy.
- Be specific in your writing and connecting to the specific aspects of theoretical understandings.
- Connect the article(s) to your own work or life experience. Share your ethical analysis from your cultural perspective.
- Check below for the grading rubric.

Grading rubric:

2 points for the meeting during class time on March 10 with a draft and sources;

2 points for clarity in the language and for being concise;

3 points for finding credible sources, submitting with the paper;

5 points for the citations and references;

4 points for the command of the course material;

4 points for student's position/opinion;

5 points for analytical writing.

Best of luck!